



Write to the Editor

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Digit will publish the best letters on these pages. Letters may be edited for clarity. You must include your complete address in all communication.

For subscription queries, call the Help Desk at 022-27629191/9200, Fax 022-27629224, or send an e-mail to help@jasubhai.com

Inbox

least these cable wallahas attend to complaints; at BSNL, I don't even know till date (trying for two months now), who the right person to take my grievance to is.

Pradeep
Via E-mail

Congratulations for completing four successful years as India's Best Tech magazine. You guys are still unbeatable! Convergence is truly going to be a part of our lives, but I fear that factors like cost, infrastructure for setting it up in mass and compatibility will pose a problem in the Indian market.

It was a real disappointment for me to read the editorial "Broadband, Narrow

stuck with a slow 40kbps line that rarely works well. This is their 'broadband'.

Considering how ignorant majority of the net users are about what an MB means, there should be laws on minimum disclosure as regards MB packs and what the meaning of broadband really is.

Harshad Oak
Via E-mail

Dear Pradeep, Nitin and Harshad, You can yourselves compare the varied reactions from different geographical areas and judge the consistency (or the lack thereof) of our broadband service providers. Moreover, the MSO problem arises where the cable operator has a large subscriber base that is potentially also a subscriber to the Internet (broadband or not in reality is a debate for another day) service that the MSO may provide. Until the MSOs actually start their service, they will not let anyone else walk away with their potential market! As for BSNL, the service is as unique as your individual experience!

—Editor

Problems with April Issue DVD

I am regular reader of *Digit* and am very happy about the fact that the *Fast Track* series will be covering varied subjects on computing. This is one of the reasons I buy *Digit*.

But when I bought the April issue, (with the book about Viruses), my adrenaline rush was gone when DVD was unable to run even a single file.

When I contacted news stand, I was told he had nothing to do with this. Since I was not a subscriber, I thought you won't be replacing the DVD.

When I was going through your June issue, there was good news. In the *Digit* Forum column, I found out that even some of your other readers also had the same experience and how they got the fresh copy.

I thought I might also try for it...

Raghavendra Prabhu
Mangalore

Dear Raghavendra, Yes, it's widely acknowledged that there were problems with April Issue DVD. Your address details have been forwarded to our Helpdesk and you should be receiving replacement DVD for April within 15 working days.

—Editor

Deep In The Core Of Technology

I have been a subscriber of *Digit* for as long as I can remember. Your Anniversary issue was par excellence and expectations and the only thing you now have to beat is yourself.

In a Utopian society, which is projected by these thoughts, one is compelled to think of trivialisation of all earthly pursuits, which today drive mankind. In my understanding of the matter, immortality would take the juice out of human life. The fact that our days are numbered makes us so special. The beauty of life lies in the fact that it is limited. Certainly immortality would end reproduction, which in fact, would mean the perpetual inhabitation of this planet by the same set of people.

Since we would be immortal, our intellects would all be used up in further perfection, and when the present people set is out of ideas the society would essentially become stagnant.

When originally we were trying to define Cyborgs as a convergence of human and machine, and were discussing the fact that even a clothed individual could be considered a quasi-cyborg (majorly human, minorly artificial), we would then actually become the same quasi-cyborg (only this time, majorly machine and minorly human thanks to conversion).

The notion that everybody will be happy is ridiculous (and so is the notion of Utopia). Human beings derive happiness from the miserable state of others.

Yes, our present way of survival has destroyed half the planet and our brains work with body and senses in compatibility mode. But the idea of a totally sedated-mechanised-thoughtless-desireless-perfect society is just too scary. I feel blessed that I shall die in 70 years without having to experience this horror.

Still, thanks to *Digit* for the food for thought. Under the shell of the glitzy machinery, your articles have the light of deep rooted wisdom.

Aritra Das
Via-E-mail

LETTER
OF THE
MONTH

Editorial

Broadband, Narrow Minds



"Only if the mighty MSO deems fit, will you get a broadband connection."

people to wait for ISPs to give Broadband through cables. I live in a region of Ahmedabad where none of the ISPs; Satyam, Icenet, etc; provide broadband service even after two years of their existence in Ahmedabad. The option was to go in for either for Tata or Reliance, but their offers were not as attractive.

BSNL, though, gave me a 256 Kbps connection at Rs 500 per month (apart from the initial cost of Rs 3,100) on my telephone line within three days of inception of its service. So I don't get the point as to why people living in big cities like Mumbai should be at the mercy of their MSO for a broadband connection.

Nitin Gajjar
Ahmedabad

I read your columns that advocate 'real' broadband in India. The current situation is pathetic. I have had a long trail of interactions with Iqara. The situation seems hopeless. I did not fall for the stupid MB packages but even with the unlimited connection, I am